



**Juniper Health**

FREE PRINTABLE PLANNER FOR FAMILIES

# Our autism planner

A planner and tracker for parents and autistic children to use together. Track sleep, feelings, food and overwhelm, plan for changes, and set goals that matter to your child.

This planner belongs to

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And my grown-up

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Date we started

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# How to use this planner

This planner is for you and your child to use **together**. It helps you notice patterns, plan for tricky times, share what works with school and professionals, and work on goals that matter to your child.

Look for the label in the top corner of each page:

- ☐ **Fill in together:** talk it through and fill it in side by side
- ☐ **For grown-ups:** records and plans for you to keep
- ☐ **For me:** pages written for your child, in their own words or drawings

## Tips that help

- **Go at your child's pace.** Use one page at a time. You do not need to fill in everything.
- **Let your child answer in their own way:** words, drawings, symbols, photos, pointing, or typing.
- **Build on strengths and interests.** Use what your child loves to make goals and plans more fun.
- **Goals should help your child, not make them hide who they are.** Avoid goals about stopping stimming or making eye contact. Focus on comfort, safety, independence and what your child wants.
- **Look for patterns, not blame.** Trackers help you spot what leads to good days and hard days.
- **Print the pages you use most,** such as the weekly tracker, as many times as you need.
- **Take it to appointments.** Your notes are useful evidence for school, health and benefit claims such as DLA.

**A note on words.** We say "autistic child", which many autistic people prefer. Please use the words your family and your child feel comfortable with.

This planner is general information to help you organise and plan. It is not medical advice. Talk to your GP, paediatrician or your child's school about any worries.

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## Looking after you too

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2. Notes and questions
3. Where to get help

# All about me

My name is, and I like to be called

My age and birthday

A picture of me (draw it or stick in a photo)

Things I love and am really good at

Things I do not like

My favourite things to talk about

Things that make me feel safe and calm

The best way to help me is

# My senses

Everyone's senses work differently. Some things might feel too much, and some things you might want more of. Fill this in together.

| My senses                                                               | Things that feel too much or I avoid | Things I love or look for | What helps me |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------|
| Sounds                                                                  |                                      |                           |               |
| Sights and light                                                        |                                      |                           |               |
| Touch and clothes                                                       |                                      |                           |               |
| Smells                                                                  |                                      |                           |               |
| Tastes and textures                                                     |                                      |                           |               |
| Movement and balance                                                    |                                      |                           |               |
| Body signals<br>(hunger, thirst, needing the toilet, pain, temperature) |                                      |                           |               |

My sensory toolkit (for example ear defenders, a fidget, sunglasses, a weighted blanket, a quiet space)

# My communication passport

Fill this in together, then copy it for school, clubs, relatives, doctors or anyone new. It helps people understand you quickly.

How I communicate (for example talking, signing, pictures, typing, a device)

How to help me understand (for example short sentences, give me time, show me)

How I show I am happy or interested

How I show I am worried, in pain or overwhelmed

Please do

Please do not

If I am overwhelmed, the best thing to do is

Important things to know about me (health, allergies, medicines, sensory needs)

# Our important people

Keep everyone's details in one place.

| Who                              | Name | Phone or email | Notes |
|----------------------------------|------|----------------|-------|
| GP                               |      |                |       |
| Paediatrician                    |      |                |       |
| Health visitor or school nurse   |      |                |       |
| School or nursery                |      |                |       |
| SENCO                            |      |                |       |
| Class teacher or key worker      |      |                |       |
| Speech and language therapist    |      |                |       |
| Occupational therapist           |      |                |       |
| CAMHS or mental health team      |      |                |       |
| Social worker or early help      |      |                |       |
| Local SENDIASS (free SEN advice) |      |                |       |
| Dentist                          |      |                |       |
| Pharmacy                         |      |                |       |
| Respite or short breaks          |      |                |       |
| Emergency contact                |      |                |       |

# Health and diagnosis record

Diagnosis, date and who gave it

Other conditions or differences (for example ADHD, dyspraxia, epilepsy, anxiety)

## Medicines

| Medicine | What it is for | Dose and when | Started | Notes and side effects |
|----------|----------------|---------------|---------|------------------------|
|          |                |               |         |                        |
|          |                |               |         |                        |
|          |                |               |         |                        |
|          |                |               |         |                        |
|          |                |               |         |                        |

Allergies

Height and weight checks

## Assessments and reports

| Date | Assessment or report | Who did it | Key points | Copy kept? |
|------|----------------------|------------|------------|------------|
|      |                      |            |            |            |
|      |                      |            |            |            |
|      |                      |            |            |            |
|      |                      |            |            |            |
|      |                      |            |            |            |

# Our weekly routine

Fill in the regular things that happen each day. You can draw symbols or stick on pictures for your child.

|               | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri | Sat | Sun |
|---------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Morning       |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| School or day |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| After school  |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Evening       |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Bedtime       |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |

# Weekly tracker

Week starting: \_\_\_\_\_ Print this page as often as you need. A quick tick, number or word is enough.

|                                      | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri | Sat | Sun |
|--------------------------------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Sleep (hours)                        |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Mood (draw a face)                   |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Eating (good, okay, hard)            |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Toilet                               |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Medicines taken                      |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| School or nursery (good, okay, hard) |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Meltdowns or shutdowns (how many)    |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Sensory overload                     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Exercise or outdoor time             |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Screen time                          |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Something that went well             |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |

Patterns we noticed this week

# Sleep diary

Many autistic children find sleep hard. Two weeks of notes can help you and your GP spot patterns.

| Date | Wind-down started | In bed | Fell asleep | Woke in the night (times) | Woke up | Notes (screens, food, worries, naps) |
|------|-------------------|--------|-------------|---------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------|
|      |                   |        |             |                           |         |                                      |
|      |                   |        |             |                           |         |                                      |
|      |                   |        |             |                           |         |                                      |
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|      |                   |        |             |                           |         |                                      |
|      |                   |        |             |                           |         |                                      |

# Food and eating

My safe foods (foods I always feel okay eating)

Foods I really do not like, and why (taste, smell, texture, look)

## Food explorer

Trying new foods slowly, one small step at a time. Every step counts. There is no pressure to eat it.

| Food | Looked at it | Touched it | Smelled it | Licked it | Tasted it | Ate some |
|------|--------------|------------|------------|-----------|-----------|----------|
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |
|      |              |            |            |           |           |          |

Mealtime tips that help us (for example same plate, foods not touching, quiet table)

# Our meals for the week

Week starting: \_\_\_\_\_ Plan meals together. Include at least one safe food at each meal, so there is always something your child is happy to eat.

|     | Breakfast | Lunch | Dinner | Snacks | Who helps cook? |
|-----|-----------|-------|--------|--------|-----------------|
| Mon |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Tue |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Wed |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Thu |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Fri |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Sat |           |       |        |        |                 |
| Sun |           |       |        |        |                 |

Shopping list

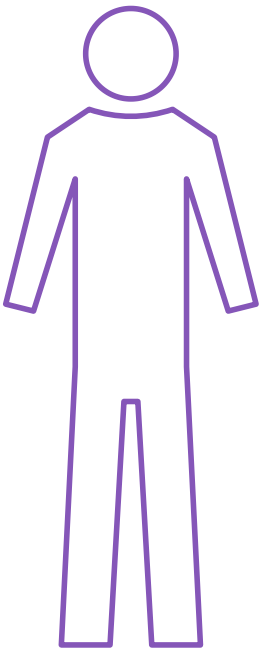
A new food we might try this week (no pressure)

Jobs I can help with (for example washing veg, stirring, setting the table)

# My feelings check-in

Circle how you feel, or draw your own face.

| Morning                                                                                                                                                        | After school                                                                                                                                                   | Evening                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>😊</div><div>Happy</div></div> <div><div>😐</div><div>Calm</div></div> <div><div>😟</div><div>Worried</div></div> <div><div>😞</div><div>Sad</div></div> | <div><div>😊</div><div>Happy</div></div> <div><div>😐</div><div>Calm</div></div> <div><div>😟</div><div>Worried</div></div> <div><div>😞</div><div>Sad</div></div> | <div><div>😊</div><div>Happy</div></div> <div><div>😐</div><div>Calm</div></div> <div><div>😟</div><div>Worried</div></div> <div><div>😞</div><div>Sad</div></div> |
| <div><div>😡</div><div>Angry</div></div> <div><div>😫</div><div>Tired</div></div>                                                                                | <div><div>😡</div><div>Angry</div></div> <div><div>😫</div><div>Tired</div></div>                                                                                | <div><div>😡</div><div>Angry</div></div> <div><div>😫</div><div>Tired</div></div>                                                                                |



**Where do I feel it in my body?** Colour in where you feel feelings, such as a tight tummy or hot face.

When I feel worried, my body

When I feel angry, my body

When I feel happy, my body

Words or signs I can use to show how I feel

# Meltdown and shutdown log

A meltdown or shutdown is not bad behaviour. It is a response to feeling overwhelmed. Noting what happened before, during and after can help you spot triggers and plan support.

| Date and time | Where and who was there | What happened before (triggers, changes, sensory, tiredness, hunger) | What it looked like | What helped | How long until calm |
|---------------|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|---------------------|
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
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|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |
|               |                         |                                                                      |                     |             |                     |

Work this out together when everyone is calm. Share it with school and family.

What it looks like, and what keeps me feeling good

## My early warning signs, and what helps me now

What helps me to be safe and calm, and what does not help

**My calm-down choices (for example quiet space, music, squeezes, movement, my special interest)**

## Page 16

# Everyday skills tracker

Track skills your child wants to work on. Fill in the date when they reach each stage. Break big tasks into small steps.

| Skill                       | With help | With prompts or a picture | On my own | Notes |
|-----------------------------|-----------|---------------------------|-----------|-------|
| Getting dressed             |           |                           |           |       |
| Brushing teeth              |           |                           |           |       |
| Washing and bathing         |           |                           |           |       |
| Using the toilet            |           |                           |           |       |
| Packing my bag              |           |                           |           |       |
| Making a snack              |           |                           |           |       |
| Using money                 |           |                           |           |       |
| Crossing the road safely    |           |                           |           |       |
| Telling someone I need help |           |                           |           |       |
|                             |           |                           |           |       |
|                             |           |                           |           |       |
|                             |           |                           |           |       |

## Choosing a goal together

The best goals come from your child. They should make life easier, safer or happier for them. Choose one or two at a time.

### Good goals are

- ☐ **Chosen together**, with your child saying what matters to them
- ☐ **About comfort, safety or independence**, not about looking less autistic
- ☐ **Small and clear**, so you both know when it is done
- ☐ **Broken into steps**, with lots of praise for each one
- ☐ **Built on strengths** and interests
- ☐ **Flexible**, so you can change them if they are not working

### Ideas to get you started

Feelings and calm

Independence and self-care

Friends and fun

School and learning

Sleep, food and health

Trying new things

**Examples:** "I can tell someone when the noise is too much", "I can get dressed with a picture list", "I can order my own drink at the cafe", "I can use my calm space when I feel amber".

## Our goal plan

My goal (in my words)

Why this matters to me

What will be different when I can do it

### Small steps to get there

**Goal!**

**Step 5**

**Step 4**

**Step 3**

**Step 2**

**Step 1**

Who can help me (home, school, others)

Things that will help (pictures, timers, practice, rewards)

Start date and when we will check how it is going

How we will celebrate

# Goal progress tracker

Colour in a star each time you practise or take a step. When the row is full, celebrate!

Goal 1



Goal 2



Goal 3



## Check-in

| Date | How is it going? (draw a face) | What is helping | What is hard | Change anything? |
|------|--------------------------------|-----------------|--------------|------------------|
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |
|      |                                |                 |              |                  |

# Planning our week

Week starting: \_\_\_\_\_ Sit down together at the start of the week.

|                              | Mon | Tue | Wed | Thu | Fri | Sat | Sun |
|------------------------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Things happening             |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Anything new or different    |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
| Fun thing to look forward to |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |

What might be tricky this week

Our plan to make it easier

One thing I want to try or practise this week

# Getting ready for changes

Changes, like a new school, a trip or a hospital visit, can feel big. Plan together and use this as a simple story.

|                                                                  |                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>What is going to happen</p>                                   | <p>When and where</p>                                                        |
| <p>Who will be there</p>                                         | <p>What I might see, hear, smell or feel</p>                                 |
| <p>What might feel hard</p>                                      | <p>What will help me (things to bring, a quiet place, a plan for breaks)</p> |
| <p>Pictures of the place or people (draw or stick in photos)</p> |                                                                              |

# First, then and next boards

Draw or stick pictures in the boxes. Cut them out and use them on the fridge, at school or when you are out.

|                  |                  |                 |
|------------------|------------------|-----------------|
| <div>First</div> | <div>Then</div>  | <div>Next</div> |
| <div>First</div> | <div>Then</div>  | <div>Next</div> |
| <div>Now</div>   | <div>Later</div> |                 |

# Our wins wall

Big or small, write down or draw every win. Look back at this page on hard days.

|                 |                 |                 |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> |
| <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> |
| <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> |
| <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> | <div>Date</div> |

# School and SEN support

School or nursery, and year group

SENCO name and contact

## SEN support at school

Schools must use their best efforts to meet special educational needs. Many children get help through "SEN support" without an EHC plan. In Wales, children with additional learning needs (ALN) get support through an Individual Development Plan (IDP).

| Need                       | Support in place | Who provides it | Is it working? |
|----------------------------|------------------|-----------------|----------------|
| Communication              |                  |                 |                |
| Sensory                    |                  |                 |                |
| Learning                   |                  |                 |                |
| Social and emotional       |                  |                 |                |
| Break and lunch times      |                  |                 |                |
| Getting to and from school |                  |                 |                |
|                            |                  |                 |                |

Reasonable adjustments agreed (for example a quiet space, movement breaks, uniform changes, a time-out card)

| Date | School contact | What we talked about | Agreed actions |
|------|----------------|----------------------|----------------|
|      |                |                      |                |
|      |                |                      |                |
|      |                |                      |                |
|      |                |                      |                |

# EHC plan tracker (England)

An Education, Health and Care (EHC) plan is a legal document for children and young people who need more support than a school can usually provide. Parents can ask the council for an assessment themselves. Your local SENDIASS can help for free.

| Stage                                   | Time limit                                   | Date | Notes |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------|-------|
| Request for assessment sent             | Day 1                                        |      |       |
| Council decides whether to assess       | Within 6 weeks                               |      |       |
| Assessment reports gathered             | Usually within 6 weeks of agreeing to assess |      |       |
| Draft plan received                     | Usually by week 14                           |      |       |
| Your comments and choice of school sent | 15 days from getting the draft               |      |       |
| Final plan issued                       | Within 20 weeks of the request               |      |       |
| Annual review                           | At least every 12 months                     |      |       |

You can appeal some decisions, such as a refusal to assess, to the SEND Tribunal. In Wales, see the IDP tracker on the next page.

Evidence to send (reports, letters, this planner, examples of difficulties)

Notes

# IDP tracker (Wales)

In Wales, children with **additional learning needs (ALN)** can get an **Individual Development Plan (IDP)**. It is a legal plan that sets out your child's needs and the support they must get. Most IDPs are made by the school. Councils make them for children with more complex needs. SNAP Cymru gives free, independent advice.

School ALNCo (ALN coordinator) name and contact

Who maintains the IDP (school or council)

| Stage                                                              | Time limit               | Date | Notes |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------|-------|
| We told the school or council we think our child has ALN           | Day 1                    |      |       |
| School decides if our child has ALN, and writes the IDP            | Within 35 school days    |      |       |
| Council decides and writes the IDP (if the council is responsible) | Within 12 weeks          |      |       |
| IDP received                                                       |                          |      |       |
| IDP review                                                         | At least every 12 months |      |       |

IDPs are built around the child, using person-centred meetings. If you disagree with a decision, you can ask the council to reconsider a school's decision, use free disagreement resolution, or appeal to the Education Tribunal for Wales.

What matters to my child (their views for the IDP)

Support written in the IDP (what, who, how often)

Evidence to share (reports, letters, this planner, examples)

# Getting ready for a meeting

Meeting with, date and time

Who is coming with me

## Before the meeting

What is going well

What we are worried about

What my child wants to say (ask them, or bring their All about me page)

Questions to ask

## After the meeting

| What was agreed | Who will do it | By when |
|-----------------|----------------|---------|
|                 |                |         |
|                 |                |         |
|                 |                |         |
|                 |                |         |

# Appointments log

| Date | Who with (doctor, therapist, service) | Why | What was said or decided | Next steps and follow-up date |
|------|---------------------------------------|-----|--------------------------|-------------------------------|
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
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|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |
|      |                                       |     |                          |                               |

## Help you may be able to get

Tick what you have, are applying for or want to look into. Rules depend on your child's needs, not just their diagnosis. Your notes in this planner can be good evidence.

| Help                                                  | What it is                                                                                      | Status (have, applied, look into) | Notes |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------|
| <b>Disability Living Allowance (DLA) for children</b> | Money towards the extra care or mobility needs of a child under 16                              |                                   |       |
| <b>Carer's Allowance</b>                              | Money for you if you care for your child at least 35 hours a week and they get certain benefits |                                   |       |
| <b>Carer's assessment</b>                             | A free council check of the support you need as a carer                                         |                                   |       |
| <b>Short breaks and respite</b>                       | Time for your child to do activities while you get a break                                      |                                   |       |
| <b>Blue Badge</b>                                     | Parking near where you need to go, if your child qualifies                                      |                                   |       |
| <b>Family Fund grant</b>                              | Grants for things like equipment, days out or a break                                           |                                   |       |
| <b>CEA cinema card</b>                                | A free cinema ticket for the person who goes with your child                                    |                                   |       |
| <b>Max Card</b>                                       | Discounts at days out for families of children with additional needs                            |                                   |       |
| <b>Disabled Facilities Grant</b>                      | Money for changes to your home, such as a safe space                                            |                                   |       |
| <b>Council Tax reduction</b>                          | Money off your bill if your home has been adapted or you are on a low income                    |                                   |       |
| <b>Local offer activities</b>                         | Your council's list of SEND services and clubs                                                  |                                   |       |
| <b>Free school transport</b>                          | Help getting to school if your child cannot walk there safely                                   |                                   |       |

Find out more at [juniperhealth.info](http://juniperhealth.info), including our free **DLA for children check**. Your council's "local offer" website lists SEND services in your area.

# Grown-up check-in

Caring for an autistic child can be joyful and exhausting. Looking after yourself helps you look after them.

## How am I doing?

|                     | Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3 | Week 4 |
|---------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| My energy (1 to 10) |        |        |        |        |
| My sleep            |        |        |        |        |
| Time for me         |        |        |        |        |
| Who I talked to     |        |        |        |        |
| Something good      |        |        |        |        |

My support network (family, friends, groups, online communities)

What I need help with right now

If you care for your child, you have the right to a free **carer's assessment** from your council. It looks at what support could help you. If you are struggling, talk to your GP, or call Samaritans free on 116 123, day or night.

One small thing I will do for me this week



## Where to get help

|                                    |                                                                            |                                    |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>National Autistic Society</b>   | Autism information and a helpline for families                             | 0800 800 4104<br>autism.org.uk     |
| <b>Contact</b>                     | Help for families with disabled children, including benefits and education | 0800 800 3555<br>contact.org.uk    |
| <b>IPSEA</b>                       | Free legal advice on special educational needs in England                  | ipsea.org.uk                       |
| <b>SNAP Cymru</b>                  | Free advice on additional learning needs and IDPs in Wales                 | snapcymru.org                      |
| <b>Your local SENDIASS</b>         | Free, independent advice on SEN and EHC plans                              | Search for your council's SENDIASS |
| <b>Family Fund</b>                 | Grants for families raising disabled or seriously ill children             | familyfund.org.uk                  |
| <b>Carers UK</b>                   | Advice and support for carers                                              | carersuk.org                       |
| <b>YoungMinds parents helpline</b> | Advice about a child's mental health                                       | youngminds.org.uk                  |
| <b>Samaritans</b>                  | If you are struggling, any time                                            | 116 123, free, day or night        |
| <b>NHS 111</b>                     | Urgent medical help that is not an emergency                               | 111 or 111.nhs.uk                  |

### About Juniper Health

Juniper Health gives clear, kind help with health conditions and disability benefits in England and Wales. It is run by Neil Hyde, trading as Juniper Health. We are independent and not part of the NHS or DWP. This planner is general information, not medical advice.

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